

The phpdfTk html-to-pdf renderer

A working tour of the engine in its current state.

What's plumbed end-to-end

The renderer parses the HTML through phpdfTk/html, runs the cascade through phpdfTk/css (with the box-edge, font, background, list-style, and text-decoration shorthand expanders), generates a box tree, lays it out, and paints the result via the existing phpdfTk/pdf-writer content stream.

The painter handles backgrounds, four-side borders, shaped text with per-glyph kerning, three kinds of text decoration, three kinds of list marker, and basic multi-page pagination.

Bullet list (default disc)

- HTML parsed by the WHATWG-conformant tokenizer + tree builder.
- CSS cascade with origins, !important, specificity, inheritance.
- Text shaping via OpenType cmap / GSUB / kern.
- Block + inline layout with greedy line breaking.

Square markers

- Sibling vertical margin collapsing per CSS 2.1 §8.3.1.
- Parent-child margin collapsing closes the §8.3.1 loop.
- Per-glyph kerning via TJ arrays when shaper advances diverge.

Outlined circle markers

- Painter approximates circles with four cubic Bézier curves.
- Marker colour follows the cascaded color.

Text alignment

Centered headline text sits at the page midpoint.

Callout

The background, border, padding, and inheritance of font / color all cooperate here without manual styling per element. This block also demonstrates `box-shadow` (hard-edged) as a subtle right/down offset set behind the callout.

And this paragraph is at 50% opacity — emitted via an `ExtGState` on the page, applied via `q /Gs gs ... Q` in the content stream so the whole paragraph (including text and background) fades together.